Lesson 6.1: Self-hosting n8n with Docker on DigitalOcean or AWS

What you learn

- **Why self-host.** More control and no per-run limits on the open-source edition, in exchange for maintaining the server. Check n8n's current licence terms for commercial use.
- **Steps.** Create a small server, install Docker, run the n8n image with a persistent volume, put it behind HTTPS with a reverse proxy, set a strong encryption key and sign-in, and back up the volume.
- **Security.** Do not expose the editor without authentication; keep the server updated.

Tools and resources (official sites, not checked live)

- n8n self-hosting
- DigitalOcean docs
- AWS docs

ASSIGNMENT

Practice for lesson 6.1

Business problem: Write a deployment checklist.

Steps

1. List the server size and cost from current price pages.
2. List the Docker, HTTPS, backup and update steps.
3. Add a restore test.

Expected output: A checklist another person can follow.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Include where the encryption key is stored and how you restore from a backup.

Check yourself

1. What must persist across restarts?
   Answer: The data volume.
2. Why HTTPS?
   Answer: To protect sign-ins and webhooks.

Lesson 6.1 of the **AI and Automation** lessons. See this lesson and its official links on skillnavora.in · All chapters and lessons · Open the full lesson guide. Tools, prices and plans change; confirm on each official site.